AIE NYC speaker cues

17:00 target | 18:00 hard stop

Glance at a cue, then speak in your own words.

01 Title hold

- Start the clock and ask the choice question on the title. Advance at “That’s from my own work.”

02 Cheaper but still failing

START 0:00

- Current agent or 28% cheaper? Switch? What else is missing?
- My opening-instruction change: cost −28% in the task family; time +4%
- No clear score gain; quality unproven
- Missed evidence; trusted the empty search
- Keep the savings? What fixes the failure?

Next: First, what are we comparing?

03 The harness flips the ranking

- 63 tasks; one run each per configuration
- OpenHands: Claude 36, GPT 31
- PI: Claude 19, GPT 38
- Ranking flipped with the harness
- Test the pairing you would deploy

Next: What decision does that result support?

04 Benchmarks and internal evaluation

CHECK 2:05

- Public results: shortlist candidates
- Internal test: today's system, representative work
- Quality, consistency across runs, total cost
- Separate people's time: check, clarify, intervene, repair
- Better for whom? By how much? How sure?

Next: Design around that decision.

05 Compare fairly

CHECK 3:20 | Two minutes here

- Tasks, repeats, pairings answer different questions
- Match setup; choose worthwhile gain before results
- Confidence interval: does it clear that requirement?
- Group related tasks; repeated runs; untouched confirmation cases
- Cheaper? Rule out unacceptable quality loss

Next: Now, follow the failure.

A narrow interval cannot fix a biased test.

06 Follow evidence into the conclusion

CHECK 5:20

- Search available? Called? Returned? Concluded?
- Empty search does not establish absence
- Same empty result; explicit search limits
- Same agent and settings; known relevant result
- Proposed tests; compare complete task outcomes

Next: What if the agent cannot use good evidence?

07 Better evidence can still go unused

- Right information; agent may not use it
- Simulation: generator bypass revealed information's value
- 41 turns; no tool call. Count non-use
- Same task and setup; control received information
- Tool-using runs may differ for other reasons

Next: And what does the score actually reward?

Starting after 6:55? Skip the simulation example.

08 Audit the score and answer key

CHECK 8:00

- One CodeProbe trial: 295 files; 6 expected; all found
- Recall 100%; precision about 2%
- F-beta about 0.025; beta 0.5
- Test good, empty and return-everything answers
- Answer key: check valid alternatives

Next: What does the gate actually stop?

09 Check what actually executes

- Release checks differ from runtime permissions; missing checks allowed execution
- Reject, cancel, remove dependency, change approved proposal
- Ordinary identity; watch execution and fallback
- Catch bad actions; allow legitimate work
- Same evaluator version for both configurations

Next: Then choose what goes to people.

10 Choose automation and review

- Agreement with human reviewers can still miss errors
- Flagged cases differ from random spot-checks
- Three model judges disagree? Human review
- Fewer automated cases; higher agreement with human labels
- 1% of 1M legitimate actions: 10,000 reviews

Next: Can the evaluator see enough?

11 Get independent evidence

CHECK 12:35

- Hearsay: 28 interventions; hash checks all passed
- Independent record detected all 28; check inserted faults reflect failures in use
- Model traffic, tool execution, destination state
- Unobserved control? Unverified; name next evidence check
- Safe to continue? Limit or stop if needed

Next: Put these checks into one decision.

12 The retrieval experiment I would run

CHECK 14:05

- Set quality/value/budget; pilot both; plan tasks and repeats
- Independent challenger: evidence, defects, valid alternatives, time
- No live actions; state changes tested in isolation
- After release: completion, repairs, latency, cost by task/version
- Audit accepted work and failures; compare traces with outcomes
- Watch workload changes; name owner and restriction/rollback triggers
- Confirmed failures become regression tests; scores must predict outcomes

Next: Back to the two opening questions.

Monitoring loop is proposed; check outcomes and act.

13 Would you switch now?

CHECK 15:50 | What evidence is still missing?

- Quality unproven; savings depend on latency, review, repair
- Search repair still needs controlled outcome tests
- Name extra action, allowed scope, human check removed
- Require repeated evidence; test evaluators and gates
- Missing evidence, failed gate, changed scope: stop; human owner

Next: Point to the procedures. Advance to resources.

14 Resources hold

- Finish near 17:00. Hold links. No added speech.

At 17:15, jump to 13: quality still unproven; search fix still untested. Then action, scope, evidence, stop conditions, human owner. Hold 14.